VICTORY 2027

First Phase Of National Movement

LECTURE-2 History

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Topics To Be Covered

1. Contributions
2. Questions
3.
4.

(c) First Phase of the Indian National Movement (1885-1907) - *objectives and methods of struggle of the Early Nationalists. Any two contributions of Dadabhai Naoroji, Surendranath Banerjee and Gopal Krishna Gokhale.*

Ques

Which of the following belongs to Dadabhai Naoroji?

(a) Gift To Monotheists
(b) My Experiments With Truth
(c) Both a & b
(d) Poverty and UnBritish rule in India



Prominent Early Nationalist Leaders

Gopal Krishna Gokhale (1866-1915)

- Gopal Krishna Gokhale, was born at Kolhapur in Maharashtra in 1866.
- He was a professor of History and Economics at Fergusson College, Pune.
- He was influenced by the ideals of Justice M.G. Ranade.
- He joined the Deccan Education Society founded by Justice Ranade. On behalf of the Society he went to England to promote Indian views before the Welby Commission. He was awarded the title of C.I.E. (Companion of the Indian Empire).



Gopal Krishna Gokhale

- Gokhale became the most popular leader of the Indian National Congress.
- He presided over the Varanasi session of the Congress in 1905.
- Having faith in British liberalism, he said "The goal of the Congress should be the attainment of a form of government similar to that which existed in the self-governing colonies of the British empire."



His Contributions

1 **Persuaded the British for Reforms:** Gokhale favoured the use of constitutional means to achieve his goals. He opposed the policies of the British Government. He criticised the Government on issues such as:

(i) Huge expenditure on the British army,
(ii) Adopting the policy of racial discrimination in appointments to high posts,
(iii) Imposing production tax on cotton.

Request

→ Indians were not appointed on high posts.

He made a strong request -to reform the Legislative Councils and separation of judiciary from the executive.

- He played an important role in the passage of Minto-Morley Reforms. 1909
- He also served as a member of the Indian Public Service Commission and urged it to increase the share of Indians in higher services.
- During his visit to England he tried to persuade the British statesmen not to approve the Partition of Bengal. politicians

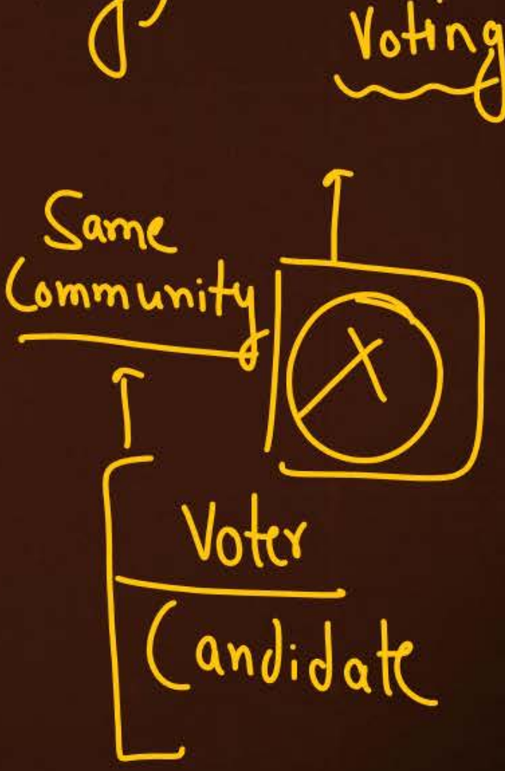
Morley-Minto Reforms (1909)

→ Morley (Secretary of State) ; Minto (Viceroy)

→ Also called Indian Councils Act

→ Introduced Separate Electorates

→ Expanded Legislative Councils
(no. of members → increased)



2 **Servants of India Society:** Gokhale set up the Servants of India Society in 1905. The main aim of the Society was to train national leaders who would dedicate themselves to the service of India. Some of the important members of the society were Srinivas Shastri and Hridaynath Kunzru.



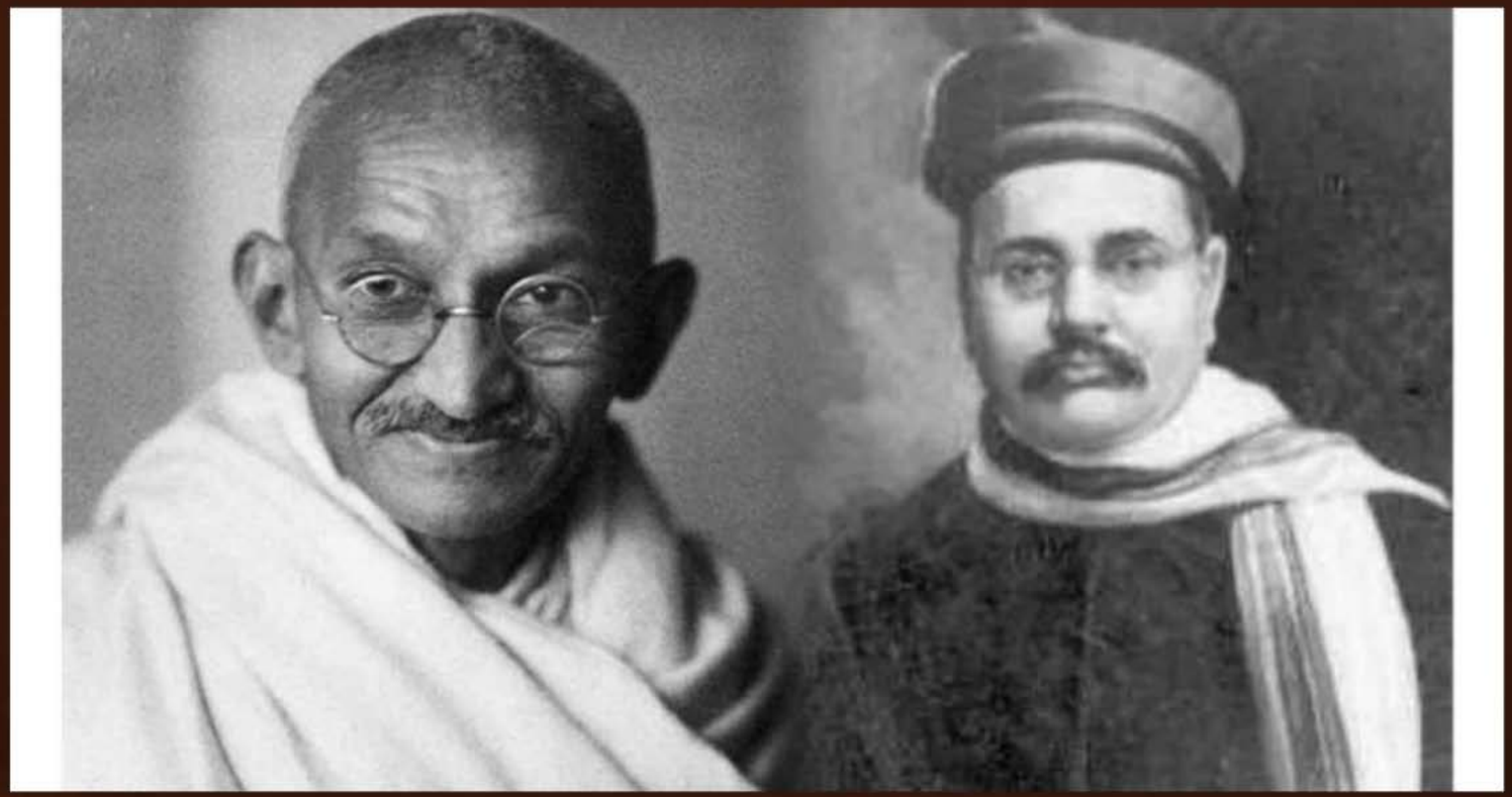
Demands → Reduce tax on Salt and cotton.
→ Bill to make primary education compulsory
Change in fiscal policy → job to educated Indians.

3 Role as a Member of Imperial Legislative Council

- In 1902 Gokhale became the member of the Imperial Legislative Council. He pleaded in the Council for reduction in Salt Duty and the abolition of excise duty on cotton goods.
- His relentless efforts led to reduction in toll tax. (↳ Tax)
- He tried to introduce a bill with a view to make primary education compulsory but he could not achieve much success in it.
- Being an economist, he demanded radical changes in the fiscal (↳ financial) policy and better jobs for the educated middle class.
- He impressed upon the government to reduce the land revenue.

Gokhale and Gandhiji: Gokhale went to South Africa where he helped Gandhiji in his fight against racial discrimination. The credit of requesting Gandhiji to return to India and join Indian public life also goes to Gokhale. Gandhiji accepted Gokhale as his 'political mentor'.

Gokhale died on February 15, 1915, when his popularity was at its peak.



Ques

Gandhi accepted _____ as his political mentor

(a) Surendranath Bannerjee

(b) Pandit Nehru

(c) G.K. Gokhale

(d) Dadabhai Naoroji

Surendra Nath Banerjee (1848-1925)

- Surendra Nath Banerjee was a nationalist leader, popular journalist and dedicated educationist.
- He was born in Bengal in 1848.
- He qualified for the Indian Civil Service Examination and posted as an Assistant Magistrate in Sylhet, Assam.
- But he was soon dismissed because he opposed the policy of racial discrimination followed by the British.

- Surendra Nath began his career as a Professor of English at the Metropolitan College. He set up his own school which later developed into Ripon College.
- In 1913, Surendra Nath was elected to both the Bengal and Imperial Legislative Councils.
- He was elected to the Calcutta Corporation and remained its member for nearly two decades.
- He was elected to the Bengal Legislative Council four times. In 1921 he was knighted and was appointed as Minister of Self-government in Bengal.

↳ granted Knighthood

He promoted constitutional methods for the attainment of India's goals. His famous saying was, "Opposition where necessary, co-operation where possible."



Surendra Nath Banerjee

His Contributions

1886 → INCon + IN Congress

1. **Established the Indian Association in 1876** to fight against the wrong policies of the British. Its aims were to educate the people; to create strong public opinion in the country; and to create political awareness and unity.

2. **Created an All-India Political Organisation:** In order to create an all-India political organisation Surendra Nath called the Indian National Conference in 1883 at Kolkata.

3. Surendra Nath Banerjee's Indian National Conference merged with the Indian National Congress in 1886 as both organizations had similar objectives. He presided over two sessions of the Congress in 1895 and 1902.

4 **Political Ideas:** Banerjee edited a newspaper, Bengalee, which served as a powerful medium for mobilising public opinion.

5 His book, A Nation in the Making, gives an account of his political concern and his views about self-government.

6 Banerjee started agitation against the License Act, Arms Act, Vernacular Press Act and against lowering the age from 21 to 19 years to appear in the I.C.S. Examination.

7 He opposed the Morley-Minto Reforms of 1909 which introduced separate electorates for the Hindus and the Muslims. He also opposed the division of Bengal by Lord Curzon in 1905.

8 **Banerjee, popularly known as the Father of Indian Nationalism, died in 1925**

He is popularly known as Father of Indian Nationalism



Ques

Surendranath Bannerjee is popularly called ____

(a) Father of Indian Nationalism

(b) Father of Renaissance

(c) Prophet of Indian Nationalism

(d) Both b & c

Statement I: Early nationalists heavily relied on the British mercy.

Statement II: They mostly favoured constitutional agitation methods.

(a) Both are incorrect

(b) Statement I is correct; II incorrect

(c) Both are Correct

(d) Statement I is false; II is Correct

Thank You

(Revise)